School Closure Report

Peninsula Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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1. School Profile

School Name
Peninsula Elementary School

Administrator
David Martinez

Location
8125 N Emerald Ave, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Peninsula is a North Portland neighborhood K–5 school. It's a collaborative community committed to authentic relationships, culturally responsive teaching, and removing barriers to student success. Its enrichment program connects classroom learning with art, music, physical education, and library instruction. Peninsula is an Inclusive school community serving students with disabilities in their neighborhood school. There are 28 classrooms on a single-story campus and approximately 225 students are enrolled for the 2026-27 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2027/2028 school year is: $20,099.

If the school is closed in 2027, the projected overall savings is $961,959. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

Under the proposed change, 45% of students would live more than one mile from Rosa Parks and would be offered school bus transportation. To accommodate these students, PPS anticipates increasing service to Rosa Parks from zero to four buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional annual cost of approximately $170,000.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	250	249	236	236	236

History of Requested and Actual Transfers

During 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 40 students requested transfers into Peninsula and 14 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 143 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools and 44 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1952	62,231 sq ft	1	6.73
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Fair; FCI .09	783 students	539 students	$5,004,615

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Peninsula is over 70 years old, and was noted as being in fair condition with a facility condition index (FCI) score of 0.09 in the 2021 Long Range Facilities Plan. The majority of the electrical distribution equipment is original to the 1953 building construction and is antiquated and the roof has aged, exceeding its design life.

ADA Accessibility
Peninsula is a single story building with an accessible main entrance.

Building Use
Currently, Peninsula houses a K–5 neighborhood school operating as an Inclusive Community School, with general education, inclusion, enrichment, and student support services.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Peninsula facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Peninsula would move its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Rosa Parks. Rosa Parks was built in 2006 and has updated facilities. Peninsula's Inclusive School Community would merge with Rosa Parks K-5's Inclusive School Community. The combined community would maintain the continuum of IEP-determined programming and supports.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional bussing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Rosa Parks was constructed in 2006, has 26 classrooms and a functional capacity of 499 students. With a combined enrollment of 481 in 2027/2028, Rosa Parks will be able to accommodate the reassigned students. Rosa Parks also has air conditioning, more modern learning spaces, and an elevator to access second-floor classrooms.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Peninsula Elementary School for the 2027–2028 school year and assigning its full neighborhood K–5 boundary to Rosa Parks. The combined school community would continue the Inclusive Community School model and IEP-determined services and supports.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-2027 school year, PPS staffs and supports 56 elementary programs. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of "well-resourced schools" as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in school year 27-28.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Peninsula and Rosa Parks within the Roosevelt cluster. Enrollment at Rosa Parks is projected to change from 160 to 481 in 2027-2028. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be three to four classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. Rosa Parks is ready to receive students throughout instructional spaces but would need minimal kitchen upgrades (warming cabinet) to adequately accommodate the new student population.

Peninsula is located approximately one mile from Rosa Parks. Rosa Parks is next door to the Charles Jordan Community Center. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. Potential barriers include longer walking distances from the Peninsula neighborhood to Rosa Parks. PPS would evaluate these needs through transportation eligibility and route reviews, and Safe Routes to School planning to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Peninsula partners with Friends of the Children to provide long-term mentoring for students. Closure is not expected to interrupt this service. Friends of the Children has a long-term commitment to each child regardless of school placement, and mentors (referred to as Friends) continue supporting students when they transition to another school. These services are provided at no cost to the District. No Racial Equity & Social Justice (RESJ) partner services at Peninsula have been identified as requiring alternatives. Additional community impacts include the adjustment for students and mentors as they reconnect in a new school setting, with proposed responses including coordinating with receiving schools so Friends can continue working with students without interruption.

Peninsula partners with the YMCA to provide child care for approximately 46 students. Relocating the program to Rosa Parks, which does not currently have an on-site child care provider, creates an opportunity to maintain care for Peninsula families while expanding access to Rosa Parks families. We ask that the YMCA and Rosa Parks administration be included in early planning discussions to identify sufficient, stable, appropriately licensed space, staffing, and operational resources to support a sustainable program. The designated space should accommodate the existing 46 Peninsula students while allowing opportunities for future enrollment growth. This transition could do more than preserve an existing partnership; it could create a valuable new community resource that supports working families and expands access to reliable, on-site child care at Rosa Parks.

Peninsula partners with Self Enhancement, Inc. (SEI) to operate its SUN Community School, providing community-based services and wraparound family supports through collaboration among PPS, Multnomah County, and the City of Portland. SEI provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, access to a food pantry and other basic-needs resources, educational and recreational activities, and culturally responsive programming supported by staff who

reflect and understand the student population. SUN also serves as an important connection point for students and families to access individualized support, community resources, enrichment opportunities, and family assistance. Closure could affect student and family access to established relationships with SUN staff, enrichment opportunities, and community resources, as well as require adjustments to programming locations, partner operations, and access to existing supports. Opportunities for partnerships to continue include transitioning students and services to Rosa Parks, which also operates an SEI-led SUN Community School. Having the same community-based organization operating SUN at both schools creates an opportunity to maintain service continuity, preserve established relationships, and coordinate student and family transitions within an existing service system. Services requiring further coordination include assessing Rosa Parks' capacity to accommodate additional students and service needs, coordinating SUN staffing and program resources, maintaining access to enrichment opportunities and basic-needs supports, and ensuring students can continue receiving individualized and wraparound services without interruption. Additional community impacts include the potential disruption of trusted relationships, neighborhood-based enrichment opportunities, and established points of connection for families accessing community resources, with proposed responses including coordinating with SEI and Rosa Parks school leadership to develop a transition plan, identify staffing and resource needs, communicate with families, and prioritize continuity of services and student participation in existing programs.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2027, with students assigned to Rosa Parks under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2027	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share principal assignments with communities.
February 2027	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2027	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2027	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.

Timeline*	Action
May 2027	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2027	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2027	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2027	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2027	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

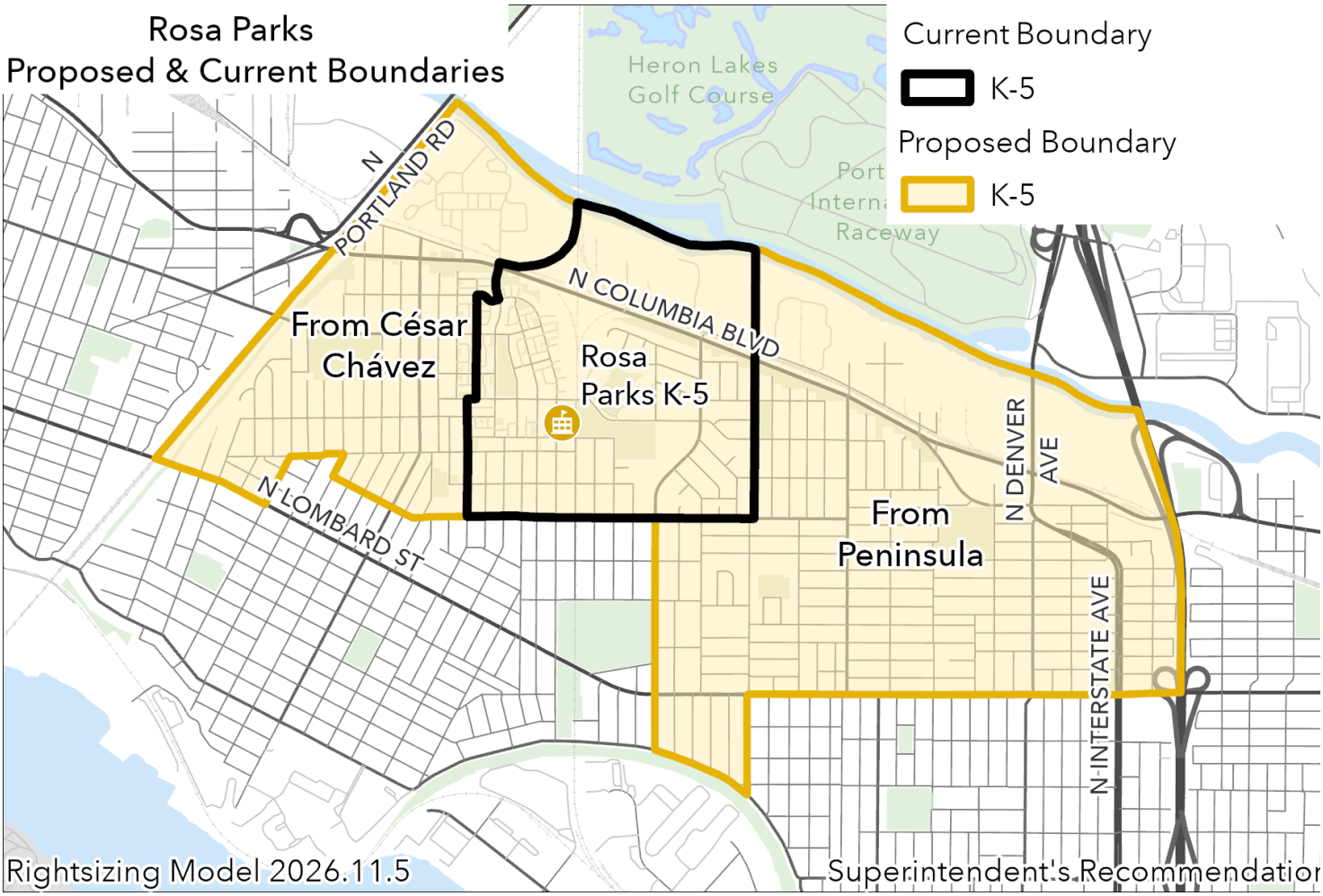
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Rosa Parks
Proposed & Current Boundaries
Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
Heron Lakes
Golf Course
Port
Interna
Raceway
N PORTLAND RD
N COLUMBIA BLVD
From César
Chávez
Rosa
Parks K-5
N LOMBARD ST
From
Peninsula
N DENVER AVE
N INTERSTATE AVE
Rightsizing Model 2026.11.5
Superintendent's Recommendation